

ED Provider Notes

Signed Jul 16, 2025

ED Provider Notes by Carl Dahlberg, MD at 7/16/2025 10:55 AM

History

Chief Complaint

Patient presents with

- Sinus Pain

CC: "For 15 years I've been having trouble with my sinuses."

HPI: 35M with PMH multiple sinus surgeries >10 years ago for indication deviated septum, PSHx non-smoker. He presents to our ED c/o >7 months of bilateral sinus congestion, L>R, associated with an intermittent a feeling of fullness in his ears, sometimes in one side and sometimes in the other. He says that based on his internet research he has become concerned that his Eustachian tubes are blocked. Between January-May of this year he was using a nasal rinse with hydrogen peroxide that "cleaned a lot of sticky stuff out" and recently he's been trying it in his ears, which has resulted in his popping noises but no real improvement in his symptoms. Today he says that his sinuses feel more blocked on the left. He has some pain from a mandibular incisor dental implant that was placed >10 years old and he wonders if it could be related to his ear symptoms. He denies fever, facial swelling, loss of hearing, vertigo, tinnitus, purulent discharge or other concerns.

Patient Active Problem List

Diagnosis

- Open angle with borderline findings and high glaucoma risk in both eyes
- Vision changes

Past Medical History:

Diagnosis	Date
• Trauma to eye	

Past Surgical History:

Procedure	Laterality	Date
• SINUS SURGERY	Bilateral	

Family History

Problem	Relation	Age of Onset
• Diabetes	Neg Hx	
• Glaucoma	Neg Hx	
• Macular degeneration	Neg Hx	

Social History

Tobacco Use	
• Smoking status:	Never
• Smokeless tobacco:	Never
Substance Use Topics	
• Alcohol use:	Not Currently
• Drug use:	Not Currently

No Known Allergies

Review of Systems

Constitutional: Negative for fever.
HENT: Positive for dental problem, rhinorrhea and sneezing. Negative for ear discharge, ear pain, facial swelling, hearing loss and tinnitus.
Eyes: Negative for visual disturbance.
Respiratory: Negative for shortness of breath.

Physical Exam

BP (!) 136/96 | Pulse 97 | Temp 36.1 °C (97 °F) (Temporal) | Resp 20 | Ht 188 cm (6' 2") | Wt 90.7 kg (200 lb) | SpO2 98% | BMI 25.68 kg/m²

Physical Exam

Constitutional:

Comments: **Alert healthy-appearing gentleman in NAD**

HENT:

Head: Normocephalic and atraumatic.

Ears:

Comments: **Normal periauricular findings and no mastoid TTP bilaterally.**

Pinnae unremarkable bilaterally.

Left TC is clear. TM is pearly without clear evidence of fluid.

Right TC is clear. TM is unremarkable with a normal light reflex.

Nose: Nose normal.

Eyes:

Comments: **Anicteric**

Neck:

Comments: **Supple, no lymphadenopathy**

ED Course

No consults were ordered

If consults were ordered, refer to the consult documentation for additional information.

Clinical Impressions as of 07/16/25 1230

Chronic sinusitis of both maxillary sinuses

Eustachian tube dysfunction, unspecified laterality

Assessment and Plan:

12:21p

Arrives well-appearing with stable vital signs. His presentation is clinically consistent with moderately symptomatic chronic sinusitis and I agree with him that he may have some degree of Eustachian tube dysfunction. I performed a limited nasal endoscopy at the bedside and I see no purulent discharge or other clinical evidence of bacterial infection today. I would like to start him on nasal steroids to see if they ease his symptoms and a 3-day

course of oxymetazoline (with cautions regarding dependence). I will refer him to the Rhinology clinic for interval follow-up and evaluation. He'll return to the ED if his symptoms change or worsen or if he has any new concerns; this was an emergent visit.

Dahlberg, Carl R, MD
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